

SENATE BILL 1613

By Jackson

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 58,
Chapter 7, relative to state veterans' homes.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 58-7-101, is amended by deleting subsection (d) and substituting instead:

(d) Each state veterans' home established pursuant to this chapter must be eligible for and receive the veterans' administration per diem payments available to qualified residents in accordance with applicable federal regulations.

(e) In addition to providing skilled nursing services, each state veterans' home may provide and receive payment for other services for the support and care of honorably discharged veterans who served in the United States armed forces as authorized by state or federal law.

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 58-7-103(c)(1), is amended by deleting the subdivision and substituting instead:

(1) The authority to determine the location and type of the Tennessee state veterans' homes, facilities, and services. In selecting the sites, preference must be given to publicly owned land. Land for the sites may be purchased only if suitable publicly owned land is not available;

SECTION 3. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 58-7-103(c)(8), is amended by deleting the subdivision.

SECTION 4. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 58-7-104(b)(3), is amended by deleting the subdivision and substituting instead:

(3) The authority to make and execute contracts and all other instruments necessary or convenient for the exercise of its powers and functions under this chapter, including contracts for the operation of the state veterans' homes and the provision of services. All contracts that pertain to the acquisition and improvement of real property pursuant to § 4-15-102 must be approved in advance by the state building commission and must be approved by the board.

SECTION 5. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 58-7-108, is amended by deleting the language "and to further the objectives and purposes of the state veterans' homes" and substituting instead "and to further the objectives and purposes of the state veterans' homes and other services".

SECTION 6. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.